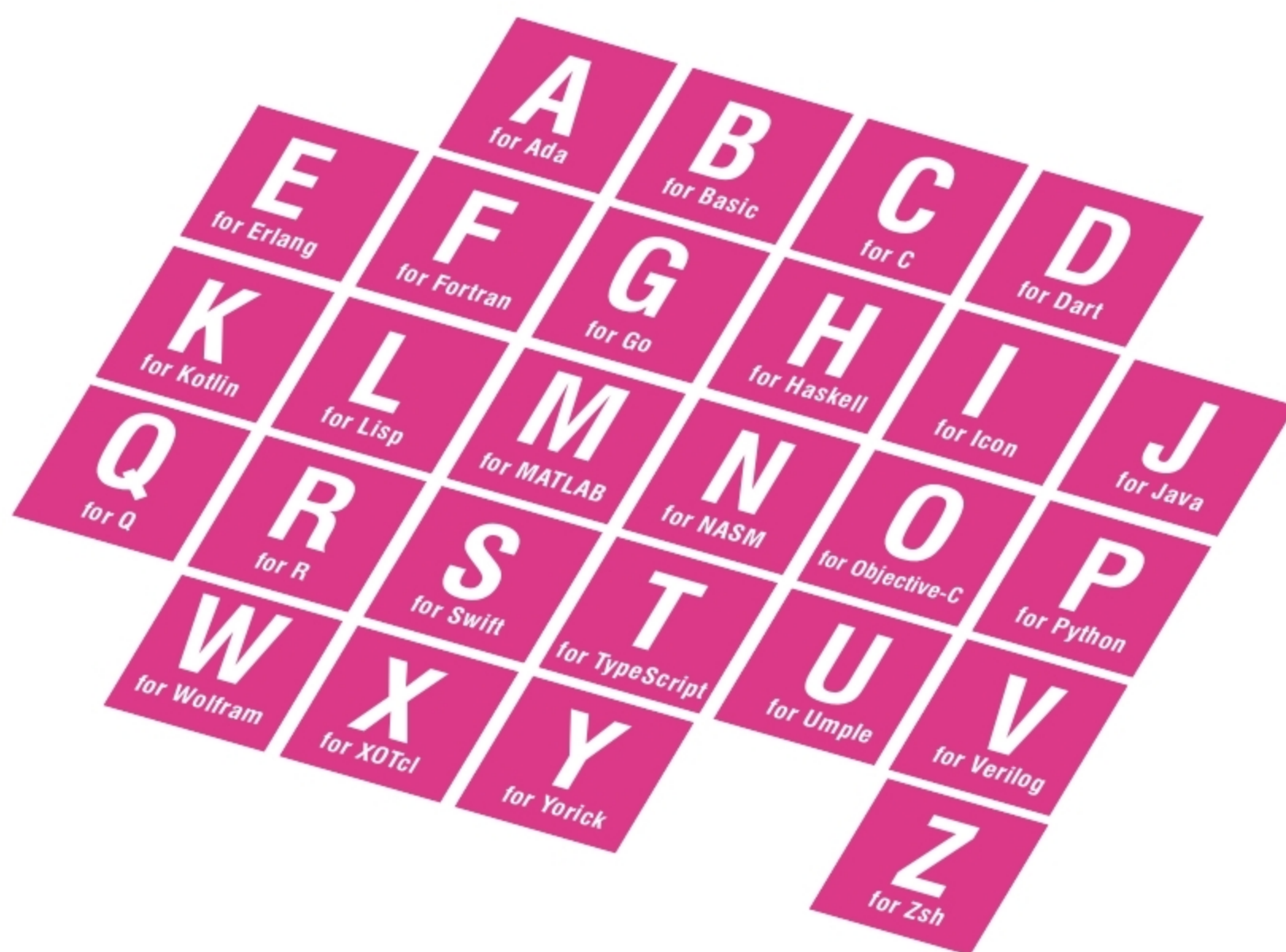


The Programming Languages Alphabet

There is a veritable alphabet soup of the starting letters of names of programming languages. The author sifts through this assortment to find the most significant programming language to represent each letter of the alphabet.



Very often, we restrict our discussions on programming languages to popular ones like Python, C, C++, Java, etc. We fail to acknowledge that there are literally thousands of programming languages out there. In this article, I try to highlight the abundance of options

by listing them alphabetically. So we are going to have, 'A for Ada, B for BASIC ...' and so on. While choosing a particular programming language, I have considered the factors of popularity, the existence of an open source compiler and historical significance. Remember that any tool that is Turing complete can be

called a programming language, thus making even C++ Templates and C Preprocessor programming languages, broadly speaking.

A for Ada

For the first letter of the alphabet I have ALGOL, AWK, AppleScript and Ada as contenders. ALGOL is